

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Chronology, 1707-1761

1707-12 Bahadur Shah -> 1712-13 Jahandar/Zulfiqar

1713-19 Farrukhsiyar/Sayyids -> 1719 brief emperors

1719-48 Muhammad Shah | 1720 Sayyid fall | 1739 Nadir Shah

1748-54 Ahmad Shah -> 1754-59 Alamgir II -> Shah Jahan III/Shah Alam II

1748-67 Abdali invasions | 1761 Third Panipat

BOUND -> Buxar 1764/Diwani 1765 and Company state belong Modern History.

MUST REMEMBER: Mughal decline was multi-causal: jagirdari stress, succession, war, regional power and fiscal-military change interacted.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Decline as a converging system

NOT -> one weak ruler + one religion + one battle + immediate collapse

STRUCTURE -> succession + noble faction + jagir/agrarian stress + war

REGION -> successor states and resistance powers reorganise authority

SHOCK -> Nadir/Abdali exploit and deepen pre-existing weakness

CONTINUITY -> dynasty, trade, agriculture and culture persist unevenly

VERDICT -> central contraction plus regional reordering.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Succession and the Sayyid wizarat

NO PRIMOGENITURE -> prince needs province + army + noble/Rajput coalition
EMPEROR -> seal/title/appointment legitimacy persists after coercive decline
WAZIR/NOBLES -> compete for access, jagirs, governorships and succession
SAYYIDS -> Abdullah + Husain Ali make/unmake emperors; Farrukhsiyar 1719
1720 FALL -> does not restore uncontested monarchy
TRAP -> Irani/Turani/Hindustani labels are networks, not permanent parties.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Four jagirdari terms

JAGIR -> transferable revenue assignment | MANSAB -> rank/service claim
PAIBAQI -> revenue pool awaiting/available for assignment
BE-JAGIRI -> delay or shortage of suitable productive assignment
JAMA -> paper assessment | HASIL -> realised collection
TRANSFER -> restrains entrenchment but encourages short-term extraction
RULE -> crisis means malfunction and scarcity, not disappearance of jagirs.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The jagirdari feedback loop

MORE CLAIMS -> mansabdars + Deccani/Maratha entrants + court rewards

POOR JAGIR -> low hasil + debt + thin contingent

EXTRACT -> short tenure encourages coercion/corruption

LOCAL RESPONSE -> zamindar bargain/resistance + peasant flight + chauth

RESULT -> still lower hasil -> faction for better office/assignment

VERDICT -> fiscal + administrative + military + social feedback.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: The inherited Deccan burden

1687-1707 -> annexation + forts + garrisons + long supply + emperor absent north

CLAIMANTS -> defeated Deccani/Maratha elites enter Mughal service system

MARATHA WAR -> parallel revenue and mobile resistance reduce collection

AURANGZEB CHOICE -> buffers removed and settlements missed

INHERIT -> earlier mansab growth + agrarian/local power + no primogeniture

TRAP -> responsibility matters, but one ruler did not create every structure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: From centre to region: a spectrum

CENTRE -> emperor retains legitimacy and titles

AUTONOMOUS PROVINCE -> Mughal governor controls revenue/army, nominal loyalty

SUCCESSOR STATE -> durable court and provincial fiscal-military regime

RESISTANCE STATE -> zamindar/community/military base builds new authority

TRIBUTE/CHAUTH -> influence without uniform direct administration

RULE -> devolution and adaptation, not simple secession or anarchy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad compared

BENGAL -> Murshid Quli Khan; revenue control + commerce + nominal tribute

AWADH -> Saadat Khan; zamindar management + Ganga military-fiscal base

HYDERABAD -> Nizam-ul-Mulk; Deccan base after withdrawal from Delhi faction

COMMON -> Mughal titles/offices/administration and Persianate court

DIFFER -> ecology, revenue, military network and company exposure

TRAP -> autonomy did not begin with modern independence declarations.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Jats, Sikhs and Marathas: bounded snapshot

JATS -> Churaman/Badan Singh/Suraj Mal; Bharatpur forts + zamindari/routes

SIKHS -> Banda phase -> repression/reorganisation -> misls/Dal Khalsa

ROHILLAS -> Afghan service/migration networks establish Rohilkhand power

MARATHAS -> Shahu + Peshwa + Holkar/Scindia/Gaekwad/Bhonsle

INSTRUMENT -> chauth/sardeshmukhi + mobile armies + bargaining

TRAP -> no single anti-Mughal bloc or uniform successor empire.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Nadir Shah, Abdali and Panipat

1739 KARNAL -> Mughal command/faction failure -> Delhi sack and extraction

NADIR -> devastating raid and exposure; not original cause or Indian annexation

ABDALI 1748-67 -> repeated Punjab/north-India interventions

1761 -> Abdali coalition defeats Marathas; Mughal emperor not main belligerent

CAUSE -> supply + alliances + non-combatants + Rohilla/Abdali coordination

LIMIT -> Panipat checks northern bid, not Maratha power or British inevitability.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal were successor states that adapted Mughal institutions, not mere evidence of anarchy.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Regional economic and cultural continuity

CONTINUE -> agriculture + textiles + internal trade + credit + urban demand

DISRUPT -> war + multiple levies + route insecurity + invasion by region

BENGAL -> commercial strength can coexist with weak Delhi centre

PATRONAGE -> Awadh/Hyderabad/Rajasthan/Punjab/Bengal/Maratha courts

ARTISTS/LITERATI -> movement creates regional styles using Mughal forms

VERDICT -> political fragmentation is not civilisational darkness.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Non-inevitability and final answer spine

PERIODISE -> 1687-1707 burden -> 1707-39 court/region -> 1739-61 multipolarity

EXPLAIN -> jagir feedback + succession/wizarat + local/regional power

SHOCK -> Nadir/Abdali reveal and deepen weakness

QUALIFY -> economy/culture and Mughal legitimacy continue unevenly

HISTORIOGRAPHY -> Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis

PYQ -> zero direct Topic-25 routes, 2018-2026; Mains has no key

BRIDGE -> fragmentation permits Company gains; Modern History explains them.